

these hurdles with our focused attention.
SANJIV GUPTA, *Perth, Australia*

Salman Rushdie has tried to defend artist M.F. Husain in his speech. If the creativity of an artist hurts the sentiments of crores of people, then the artist in question must apologise. On the other hand, Hindu organisations too should not take the law in their hands. If Husain were to apologise, he should be forgiven and all cases against him should be withdrawn. There is no doubt he is a great painter as well as an asset for India.
KHALEEL UL REHMAN, *Delhi*

Rotten Crores

The lakhs/crores of rupees that went into Mayawati's cash *mala* might well have come from dubious sources ("Crore Competency", March 29). A mainline politician indulging in lavish celebration of unaccountable money, not to mention wildly squandering public money, means that yet another pillar of political decency has fallen. That bodes ill for the nation's aspiration to be a power of consequence.
BISHAN SAHAI,
via www.indiatoday.in

Mayawati must understand that symbolism of any kind will not improve the living conditions of people. The practice of

decorating leaders with currency garlands has been in vogue for long. It is a matter of shame that in a country where thousands of people live a penurious life, a political leader humiliates us with such an uncalled-for display of money.

VINOD C. DIXIT, *Ahmedabad*

Banking on Power

Perhaps it is only in India that political leaders can



“In its present format, the Women's Reservation Bill might largely benefit the elite and politicians who may manage to get tickets for their wives and daughters, depriving those who deserve them.”

INDU SHANKAR, *Varanasi*

take the liberty of spending taxpayer money like freebies for favours to individuals ("Rental Value", March 29). The Comptroller and Auditor General of India should object to Bihar Chief Minister Nitish Kumar's undesired gesture to former state governor Buta Singh who illegally occupied a government bungalow in expensive Lutyen's Delhi.
SUBHASH AGRAWAL, *Delhi*

Swish Set

In his column, Dilip Bobb rightly points out that meritocracy has failed in enhancing the key institutions of our country ("The New Power Elite", March 22). There has grown a forward class among the Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and OBCs, who have been using the benefits of reservation over the years. As a result, those who really need to

avail these benefits are being sidelined.
BHUSHAN CHANDER JINDAL,
Jalandhar

Corrigendum

'Flight Plans' (April 5) incorrectly identified Rahul Bhatia, Group Managing Director, InterGlobe Enterprises, as Aditya Ghosh, President, IndiGo Airlines. The error is regretted.
EDITOR

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

JUNE 1-15, 1980

All 'Cock and Bull'

Justice delayed is justice denied? Not necessarily. This was illustrated when the Chief Judicial Magistrate of Patna absolved on May 7 this year, Karpooori Thakur, former chief minister of Bihar, of having raped Premilata Rai, 30, a Kathmandu-based school teacher, at the house of Professor S.N. Verma. The alleged rape took place at Verma's house in Nepal, where Thakur is said to have been in hiding. Thakur had pleaded then that he was being exploited for dubious political ends and had nothing to do with the rape of the Nepali woman. The court also described the case as a 'cock and bull story', and observed: "In the meagre materials available on record, I find sufficient materials to show that this is a case of character assassination of a political leader, maybe due to unfulfilment of expectations of S.N. Verma and others from him or the commitments of the former made to them at the time when Verma surrendered all his resources for his help."

by Farzand Ahmed



THAKUR

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